

ENGINE OF CHANGE

The World Cup's enduring influence lies in its ability to **redefine football,** on the pitch and beyond.

When the idea for the World Cup competition was proposed more than a century ago, before taking shape in 1930, it would have been hard to envisage its relevance nearly 100 years on. As the final pieces are being put together for the 23rd edition of the tournament in the USA, Mexico and Canada, let's look at how the showpiece competition has evolved over the years.

THE EARLY YEARS

During its formative period, the World Cup established itself amid scepticism over host selections between 1930 and 1938. Three successful editions later, the tournament was cancelled in 1942 and 1946 due to the second World War, only before resuming in 1950.

URUGUAY
1930



1st

A special voyage begins: The French national team players pose for a group picture during their 15-day cruise aboard the 'Conte Verde' in July 1930, on their way to Uruguay to participate in the first World Cup. AFP